

Key Competencies:

- Deep sense of ownership
- Strong bias to action
- Uncompromising attention to detail
- Ability to dive deep to answer questions
- Drive to create impact
- Refreshingly humble and relentlessly curious
- Excellent stakeholder management and hyper-compassionate

Interview style:

Past performance is the best indicator of future performance; While it matters that this candidate has the chops to excel in this role, it is not a requirement that they have done this exact job before. Rather, we seek to understand if and how they've excelled in past roles to understand if they can learn and grow into this role. Please use the STAR interview method (e.g. behavioral interview questions) and leverage the below sample questions and competency indicators. Sample questions provided below will offer an opening question as well as additional probing/clarifying questions. It is also acceptable to also pose a single case question in which you state a hypothetical scenario and ask the candidate how they would approach the problem.

Interviewing for ownership:

What is it: Thinking long term and not sacrificing long-term value for short-term results. Acting on behalf of the entire company, beyond just their team. NEVER saying "that's not my job"

Strength indicators:

- Actively makes improvements outside of area of responsibility
- Makes decisions that consider risks and future outcomes
- Makes decisions that are scalable and contribute to long term success
- Takes lead in solving problems
- Takes accountability for dependencies and their work
- Takes ownership of mistakes
- Accepts responsibility

- Inspires others to take ownership
- Sees things through to completion

Red flags:

- Makes decisions for short-term success rather than long-term value
- Describes setbacks and problems without talking about how to address them
- Relies on others to remove roadblocks
- Avoids tough decisions
- Avoiding addressing problems that are in others' work areas
- Blames others for setbacks
- Assigns work to others because work is undesirable
- Walks away if there are too many difficulties
- Creates solutions that negatively impact other teams

Suggested behavioral interview questions:

- 1. Tell me about a time when you didn't have enough data to make the right decision.** What did you do? What path did you take? Did the decision turn out to be the correct one?
- 2. Tell me about a strategic decision you had to make without clear data or benchmarks.** How did you make your final decision? What alternatives did you consider? What were the tradeoffs of each? How did you mitigate risk?
- 3. Tell me about a time when you made a difficult decision with input from many different sources (customers, stakeholders, partner teams, and so on).** What was the situation and how did you arrive at your decision? Did the decision turn out to be the correct one? Why or why not?
- 4. We don't always make the right decision all the time.** Tell me about a time when you made a bad decision. What was the impact of that decision? What did you learn? How have you applied what you learned?
- 5. We don't always make the right judgment all the time.** Tell me about a time when you made an error in judgment. What was the impact? What did you learn? How have you applied what you learned?
- 6. Tell me about a time when you discovered that your idea was not the best course of action. What was your idea?** Why wasn't your idea the best course of action? How did you find out it was not the correct path? What was the best course of action? Who provided it? What did you learn from the experience?
- 7. Describe a time when you brought different perspectives together to solve a problem.** What types of different perspectives were represented? How did you seek out different points of view? What was the outcome? Were there any key learnings from this experience? Knowing what you know now, would you have done anything different?

Interviewing for **bias to action**:

What is it: Speed matters in business. Decisions and actions are reversible and do not need extensive study. Calculated risk taking is deeply valued.

Strength indicators:

- Able to Move quickly on a project, even when some information is lacking
- Understands when to consult others and when it's not necessary
- Willing to make small progress towards a solution rather than finding the perfect solution right away
- Deals with problems quickly so others can make progress
- Carefully considers what is important to get done right away and what can wait

Red flags:

- Moves slower than necessary when faced with incomplete information
- Hesitates longer than necessary when making even small decisions
- Fears making mistakes and doing things that have not been done before

Suggested behavioral interview questions:

1. **Give me an example of a calculated risk that you have taken where speed was critical.** What was the situation and how did you handle it? What steps did you take to mitigate the risk? What was the outcome? Knowing what you know now, would you have done anything differently?
2. **Tell me about a time when you worked against tight deadlines and didn't have time to consider all options before making a decision.** How much time did you have? What approach did you take? What did you learn from the situation?
3. **Describe a situation where you made an important business decision without consulting your manager.** What was the situation and how did it turn out? Would you have done anything differently?
4. **Tell me about a time when you had to gather information and respond immediately to a situation.** What was the outcome? Would you have done anything differently?
5. **Give me an example of when you had to make an important decision and had to decide between moving forward or gathering more information.** What did you do? What was the outcome? What information is necessary for you to have before acting?
6. **Tell me about a time when you saw an issue that would impact your team and took a proactive approach to solve it.** What was the issue? What did you do and what was the outcome? What did you learn from this situation?

Interviewing for attention to detail:

What is it: Having relentlessly high standards - many people think these standards are unreasonably high. Continually raising the bar and drive to deliver the highest quality product and processes. Ensuring that defects do not get sent down the line and that problems are fixed so they stay fixed.

Strength indicators:

- Sets and commits to goals that are challenging yet realistic
- Review work extensively and offers high quality feedback

- Communicates and gets agreement on expected standards
- Builds systems that are scalable and serve customer needs
- Continually tries to improve processes

Red flags:

- Emphasized speed over quality for most projects
- Fails to recognize long-term impact of lower standards
- Creates or accepts goals that are too easily achievable
- Accepts quick solutions to problems with minimal follow-up to ensure they are addressed

Suggested behavioral interview questions:

1. **Describe a time when you refused to compromise your standards around quality/customer service, and so on.** Who was your customer? What was the result?
2. **Tell me about a time when you were unsatisfied with the status quo.** What did you do to change it? What was the impact? Would you do anything differently in the future?
3. **Tell me about a time when you worked to improve the quality of a product/service/solution that was already getting good customer feedback.** Why did you think it needed improvement? How did customers react?
4. **Tell me about a time when you had to make a decision between standards and delivery.** What tradeoffs did you have to make? What was the outcome? Knowing what you know now, would you have done anything differently?
5. **Give me an example of a goal you've had where you wish you had done better.** What was the goal? How could you have improved on it?
6. **Describe the most significant continuous improvement project that you led.** What was the catalyst to this change and how did you go about it? What was the outcome?

Interviewing for create impact:

What is it: Focus on the key inputs for their business and deliver them with the right quality and in a timely fashion. Despite setbacks, they rise to the occasion and never settle. Moves the needle at the organization-level.

Strength indicators:

- Can speak to and quantify how they drive value, and demonstrates it often
- Meets deadlines with expectations with products that are well-executed and high-quality
- Focuses on delivering the most important products
- Able to deliver multiple projects at the same time
- Overcomes and persists in the face of obstacles
- Communicates regularly about the status of projects

Red flags:

- Cannot clearly speak to how they demonstrate value that makes them irreplaceable

- Fails to deliver on required commitments
- Does not commit adequate time and resources to deliver quality results
- Settles for work products that do not meet expectations
- Makes excuses for why things cannot be done
- Delivers projects late or with missing requirements

Suggested behavioral interview questions:

1. **Give me an example of a time when you were able to deliver an important project under a tight deadline.** What sacrifices did you have to make to meet the deadline? How did they impact the final deliverable? What was the final outcome?
2. **Tell me about a time when you had significant, unanticipated obstacles to overcome in achieving a key goal.** What was the obstacle? Were you eventually successful? Knowing what you know now, is there anything you would have done differently?
3. **Tell me about a time when you not only met a goal but considerably exceeded expectations.** How were you able to do it? What challenges did you have to overcome?
4. **Tell me about a time when you or your team were more than half way to meeting a goal when you realized it may not be the right goal or may have unintended consequences.** What was the situation? What did you do? What was the outcome? Looking back, would you have done anything differently?
5. **Give me an example of a mission or goal you didn't think was achievable.** What was it and how did you help your team try to achieve it? Were you successful in the end? Looking back, would you have done anything differently?
6. **Tell me about a time when you did not effectively manage your projects and something did not get completed on time.** What was the impact? What approaches do you use to make sure you are focusing on the right deliverables when you have several competing priorities?

Interviewing for diving deep:

What is it: Ability to operate at all levels, stay connected to the details, audit frequently, and be skeptical when metrics and anecdotes differ. No task is beneath you.

Strength indicators:

- Stays connected to the details of a project and programs
- Understands how different groups or systems work together
- Critically evaluates metrics and data
- Asks good questions that provide clarity to situations
- Steps in and gets work done
- Investigates and gets details in order to solve a problem
- Gathers information to solve a problem, even if it's difficult or time-consuming

Red flags:

- Does not understand the details of a projects

- Does not understand how different groups or systems work together
- Only holds surface-level understanding of metrics and data
- Does not question assumptions
- Unable to step in and get work done

Suggested behavioral interview questions:

1. **Tell me about a time when you were trying to understand a complex problem on your team and you had to dig into the details to figure it out.** Who did you talk with or where did you have to look to find the most valuable information? How did you use that information to help solve the problem?
2. **Tell me about a situation that required you to dig deep to get to the root cause.** How did you know you were focusing on the right things? What was the outcome? Would you have done anything differently?
3. **Tell me about a problem you had to solve that required in-depth thought and analysis.** How did you know you were focusing on the right things? What was the outcome? Would you have done anything differently?
4. **Walk me through a big problem or issue in your organization that you helped to solve.** How did you become aware of it? What information did you gather? What information was missing and how did you fill the gaps? Did you do a reflection at the conclusion of the project? If so, what did you learn?
5. **Tell me about a specific metric you have used to identify a need for a change in your department.** Did you create the metric or was it already available? How did this and other information influence the change? What was the outcome of this change?
6. **Have you ever created a metric that helped identify a need for a change in your department?** What was the metric? Why did you create it? How did this and other information influence change? What was the outcome of the change?

Interviewing for intellectual humility and curiosity:

What is it: Never done learning and always seeking to improve themselves. They are curious about new possibilities and act to explore them

Strength indicators:

- Seeks opportunities to explore new possibilities and learn new skills
- Shows curiosity about how things work
- Consistently asks “I wonder what would happen if...” to make continual improvement
- Accepts new and challenging situations, despite the risk of failure
- Willing to pursue knowledge
- That does not have an immediate gain or deliverable
- Seeks and embraces feedback from others
- Discusses lessons learned and past setbacks
- Currently working on initiatives to improve themselves

Red flags:

- Prefers to stay with familiar situations and use existing skillset
- Actively avoids new experiences or trying new things
- Avoids, disregards, or acts defensively towards feedback from others
- Reacts to negative situations by focusing on what went wrong instead of how to improve in the future
- Does not take steps to improve

Suggested behavioral interview questions:

1. **Tell me about a time when you realized you needed a deeper level of subject matter expertise to do your job well.** What did you do about it? What was the outcome? Is there anything you would have done differently?
2. **Describe a time when you took on work outside of your comfort area.** How did you identify what you needed to learn to be successful? How did you go about building expertise to meet your goal? Did you meet your goal?
3. **Tell me about a time when you didn't know what to do next or how to solve a challenging problem.** How do you learn what you don't know? What were the options you considered? How did you decide the best path forward? What was the outcome?
4. **We all have things about ourselves we'd like to improve on at work. Give me an example of something that you've worked on to improve your overall work effectiveness.** What resources did you identify to help you develop? What was the impact?
5. **Give me an example of a time when you explored a new or unexpected area of an existing space.** Why hadn't this been explored already? Why did you move forward? What were the results or what was the impact?
6. **Describe a time when someone on your team challenged you to think differently about a problem.** What was the situation? How did you respond? What was the outcome?
7. **Tell me about a time when you used external trends to improve your own company's products or services.** How did you keep up to date with external trends? How did you decide to apply them to your own company? What was the result?

Interviewing for compassion & team-work:

What is it: Proclivity to listen attentively, speak candidly, and treat others with respect. They are vocally self-critical, even when doing so is awkward or embarrassing. They do not think their body owner smells of perfume. They benchmark themselves against the best.

Strength indicators:

- Builds positive working relationships by treating others and their ideas with respect
- Seeks out and accepts feedback for self
- Takes responsibility of shortfalls
- Openly acknowledges mistakes
- Provides feedback to others in a respectful manner

- Represent data and information entirely transparently
- Honors commitments and makes good on promises

Red flags:

- Fails to treat others and their ideas with respect
- Blames others for mistakes
- Denies or covers up mistakes
- Publicly criticizes or humiliates team members

Suggested behavioral interview questions:

1. **Tell me about a time when you had to communicate a change in direction that you anticipated people would have concerns with.** What did you do to understand the concerns and mitigate them? Were there any changes you made along the way after hearing these concerns? How did you handle questions and/or resistance? Were you able to get people comfortable with the change?
2. **Give me an example of a tough or critical piece of feedback you received.** What was it and what did you do about it?
3. **Describe a time when you needed to influence a peer who had a differing opinion about a shared goal.** What did you do? What was the outcome?
4. **Give me an example of a time when you were not able to meet a commitment.** What was the commitment and what were the obstacles that prevented success? What was the impact to your customers/peers and what did you learn from it?
5. **Tell me about a time when your team's goals were out of alignment with another team you relied on in order to meet your goal.** How did you work with the other team? Were you able to achieve your goals?
6. **Tell me about a time when you uncovered a significant problem in your team.** What was it and how did you communicate it to your manager and other stakeholders? What did you do to address the problem? How did you manage the impact of this problem for the rest of your team?
7. **Describe a time when you improved morale and productivity on your team.** What were the underlying problems and their causes? How did you prevent them from negatively impacting the team in the future?
8. **Tell me about a time when a team member was struggling to keep up or fit in and you stepped in to help out.** Why did you think they were struggling or not fitting in? Why did you decide to step in and support? What did you do to help out? How did it impact your work? What was the outcome? What did you learn from that situation?
9. **Tell me about a time when a team member was not performing well and impacted your work.** How did you handle that situation? Why were they not performing well? What was the outcome? What did you learn from that situation?

Interviewing with **case question**

What is it: Asking candidate hypothetical scenario question to understand their thought and problem solving process

Strength indicators:

- Candidate asks clarifying questions to make sure they understand the premise. Examples:
 - Who is my customer?
 - What are my goals? How is success measured?
 - How can we measure our KPIs?
 - What are the milestones I need to track?
 - What is our vision?
- Shows clarity (but not necessarily linearity) in thought process
- Vocally articulates trade-offs, but commits to a best-judgment recommendation on approach

Red flags:

- Chokes or cannot understand premise
- Does not attempt to quantify success and how it will be measured
- Shows lack of problem-solving process

Example questions (feel free to be creative, but not cruel, in thinking of interesting and unique scenarios)

- You are in charge of growing WAU for a enterprise tool used by all employees in a company - walk me through how you would flesh out a growth strategy?
- You need to increase member subscriptions for a consumer service, but have a very targeted, small TAM. Where do you start to create a roadmap for growth?
- You are tasked with measuring the success of a long-live legacy product with no existing quantified KPIS and proposing new metric targets for growth. How do you approach this and what questions are you asking?

